Multiple modifiers can be added to an expression, for example, `/pattern/Aix` would set the pattern matching to be anchored, case insensitive, and multiline. We'll look at a few of the modifiers now, and the rest when they become relevant as we work through this section. First of all, here's `i` and `x` modifiers in action:

```
var_dump(preg_match('/ToAsT/i', 'toaster'));
var_dump(preg_match('/To A sT/ix', 'toaster'));
```

```
Output:
int(1)
int(1)
```

The effects are fairly self-explanatory: our search pattern contains an assortment of uppercase and lowercase ASCII letters, but with the `i` modifier we still get a positive result from `preg_match()`. By adding `x` as a second modifier, all of the spaces in the pattern are ignored (otherwise they would have been treated as literal space characters and resulted in no match). To apply a regex pattern from the start of the sample, you can use the `A` modifier:

```
var_dump(preg_match_all('/toast/', 'toaster toaster'));
var_dump(preg_match_all('/toast/A', 'toaster toaster'));
```

```
Output:
int(2)
int(1)
```

By "anchoring" the pattern to the very beginning of the sample, we can only match the pattern once, even though it occurs multiple times in the sample. Note the use of `preg_match_all()` here; this is where PHP's implementation of PCRE differs slightly from Perl and other PRCE engines: other languages offer a `g` modifier for "global" matching where the pattern is applied throughout the entire string (otherwise it only has to match once). PHP does away with this modifier and enables it automatically, except for `preg_match()`. Now that we know how to anchor the pattern, we need to look at another modifier which controls how this anchoring is applied to complex sample text.

The multiline modifier – `m` – has subtle but profound effect on the PCRE engine. Without the `m` modifier, the entire sample string is simply one byte stream to which the pattern is applied across the entire length. If `m` is specified, the sample is treated as multiple strings, delimited by the *0x0A* newline character. The following example should make this clear; we'll also have a sneak peak at some more metacharacters: